

Relationships and infrastructure programmes

I am an **empanelled arbitrator** for infrastructure projects. I am also a member of dispute resolution boards in a few such contracts. This is the result of a change in my professional **trajectory** towards infrastructure almost 27 years ago. **My experience** as a project person, and now as a **conciliator**, **has** made me realise that **securing** a contract is relatively easier than **execution** due to **ambiguity**, inadequate study and interpretation of the contract by both the involved parties, namely the client and the contractor.

A third **entity** by the name of consultant **is** sometimes introduced in big-size projects with the purpose of ensuring a smooth and timely completion without any conflicts. They too **add to** the confusion. This is despite a reasonably good document, detailed discussions and clarifications before bidding, and the best intentions and efforts of all the parties to successfully complete and close the contract.

I realise that **marital** relationship is no different. It is a contract without a written document. I understand that many young couples have now started getting into written **pre-nuptial agreements**. **The entire process**, whether in projects or in relationships, **is** similar. In most of the middle-class families, both sets of parents start framing details of requirements and the terms of offer. It is both interesting and simultaneously disappointing to note that **the two persons** who are going to spend rest of their lives together, even after the parents are gone, **do not bother** to involve themselves in the exercise, despite being in a better position to do so with education and availability of information on the internet. They need to be more involved. Things are looking up as many youngsters are willing to take charge of their future life. There is a period of **courtship**, and sometimes even a **live-in**, to **ascertain** the **suitability** of entering into the agreement, or even update or **amend** the **terms** of engagement.

The **responses** from the prospective applicants **are evaluated**. There is a shortlist. The final selection is made after discussions and based on mutually agreed techno-commercial terms. I **consciously** use the word 'commercial'. It is a sad reality. A date is finalised for the formal signing of the agreement.

Both the parties **indulge in** a lot of self-congratulatory and joint celebrations through age-old ceremonies before the wedding date. We now **encounter** two important consultants, one from each side, the priests, who shall **administer** the terms of the understanding between the bride and the groom through a series of **elaborate** rituals. It is a different matter that **much** of these instructions **are** in a language which now very few understand, least of all the two involved parties, who are lost to the world in the **euphoria** of the moment. With the **wisdom** of age, and availability of material on the internet, I can now say that the **vows** taken at marriage would probably **result in** happier and long-lasting relationships if the promises are made after a good understanding much before the W-Day. Many do lead a **contented** life till the end, **riding the crests and troughs**. However, it is **well-nigh** impossible to be perfect where human emotions are involved despite best intentions. **Couples**, at

least till my generation, **were** brought up with the belief that the terms of this bond were **divine** and life-long, and we **mortals** did not have the authority to change them. The youngsters do not think so. They would rightly and justifiably **terminate** a relationship if it does not give them satisfaction and happiness.

This does not sit well with the parents and well-meaning relatives. They judge the young through the lens of their values. They would still advise the couple to give it a little more time. This **attempt** at finding a solution through the efforts of the conciliators, or the dispute members or the arbitrators, **may** or may not work. **The two parties**, after having **exhausted** all other measures for an **amicable** solution, **may** engage lawyers to meet in the court of law.

This is also the life cycle of infrastructure and other projects. They also **go through** the same **pangs**. Contract execution or administration or management is a **microcosm** of life. Relationships are **fragile** and **ought to be nurtured** with clarity and clear understanding of the terms. However, there should be no **hesitation** to terminate the agreement, without **acrimony**, if the situation so **warrants**. Life must keep moving.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Infrastructure** (noun) – Framework, foundation, base, support system, facilities
बुनियादी ढांचा
2. **Empanelled** (adjective) – Appointed, enlisted, designated, selected, authorized
पैनलबद्ध
3. **Arbitrator** (noun) – Mediator, judge, umpire, adjudicator, negotiator
मध्यस्थ
4. **Trajectory** (noun) – Path, course, route, direction, arc
पथ
5. **Conciliator** (noun) – Mediator, peacemaker, negotiator, intermediary, reconciler
समझौता कराने वाला
6. **Secure** (verb) – Obtain, acquire, gain, procure, ensure
प्राप्त करना
7. **Execution** (noun) – Implementation, enforcement, carrying out, performance, accomplishment
कार्यान्वयन
8. **Ambiguity** (noun) – Uncertainty, vagueness, obscurity, doubleness, indistinctness
अस्पष्टता
9. **Add to** (phrasal verb) – Increase, amplify, augment, intensify, enhance
बढ़ाना
10. **Marital** (adjective) – Matrimonial, spousal, wedded, conjugal, nuptial
वैवाहिक
11. **Pre-nuptial agreement** (noun) – a contract made by a couple before they marry, outlining how their assets and liabilities will be divided if they divorce
पूर्व वैवाहिक समझौता
12. **Bother** (verb) – Mind, concern, trouble, care, disturb
परेशान होना
13. **Courtship** (noun) – Wooing, dating, romance, engagement, love affair
प्रेम-प्रसंग
14. **Live-in** (noun) – a person who shares another's living accommodation as a sexual partner or as an employee.
15. **Ascertain** (verb) – Determine, verify, confirm, discover, establish
पता लगाना
16. **Suitability** (noun) – Appropriateness, fitness, adequacy, aptness, compatibility
उपयुक्तता
17. **Amend** (verb) – Modify, revise, alter, adjust, update
संशोधित करना
18. **Terms** (noun) – Conditions, clauses, provisions, stipulations, agreements
नियम / शर्तें
19. **Evaluate** (verb) – Assess, judge, estimate, appraise, rate
मूल्यांकन करना
20. **Consciously** (adverb) – Deliberately, intentionally, knowingly, purposely, mindfully
जानबूझकर / सचेत रूप से
21. **Indulge** (in) (verb) – Participate, engage, take part, revel, wallow
लिप्त होना

22. **Encounter** (verb) – Meet, face, come across, confront, stumble upon सामना करना
23. **Administer** (verb) – Manage, conduct, supervise, execute, implement संचालन करना
24. **Elaborate** (adjective) – Detailed, intricate, ornate, complex, thorough विस्तृत
25. **Euphoria** (noun) – Elation, joy, ecstasy, happiness, exhilaration उत्साह
26. **Wisdom** (noun) – Knowledge, insight, understanding, prudence, sagacity बुद्धिमत्ता
27. **Vow** (verb) – Pledge, promise, swear, commit, affirm संकल्प लेना
28. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – Lead to, cause, bring about, culminate in, end in का कारण बनना
29. **Contented** (adjective) – Satisfied, pleased, happy, fulfilled, at peace संतुष्ट
30. **Ride the crests and troughs** (phrase) – to be very successful for a limited period of time उतार-चढ़ाव झेलना
31. **Well-nigh** (adverb) – Almost, nearly, virtually, practically, close to लगभग
32. **Divine** (adjective) – Sacred, holy, spiritual, godly, celestial दैवीय
33. **Mortal** (noun) – Human being, person, soul, individual, creature नश्वर
34. **Terminate** (verb) – End, conclude, cease, cancel, discontinue समाप्त करना
35. **Exhausted** (adjective) – Drained, tired, fatigued, depleted, spent थका हुआ
36. **Amicable** (adjective) – Friendly, peaceful, harmonious, cordial, cooperative सौहार्दपूर्ण
37. **Go through** (phrasal verb) – Experience, undergo, endure, face, live through से गुजरना
38. **Pang** (noun) – Pain, ache, stab, spasm, throe चुभन
39. **Microcosm** (noun) – Miniature version, small-scale model, epitome, reflection, replica लघु रूप
40. **Fragile** (adjective) – Delicate, weak, brittle, vulnerable, breakable नाजुक / कमजोर
41. **Ought to** (modal verb) – Should, must, need to, have to, be expected to करना चाहिए
42. **Nurture** (verb) – Foster, cultivate, nourish, support, care for पालन-पोषण करना / बढ़ावा देना
43. **Hesitation** (noun) – Reluctance, doubt, indecision, pause, uncertainty झिझक

44. **Acrimony** (noun) – Bitterness, resentment, hostility, spite, rancour कटुता

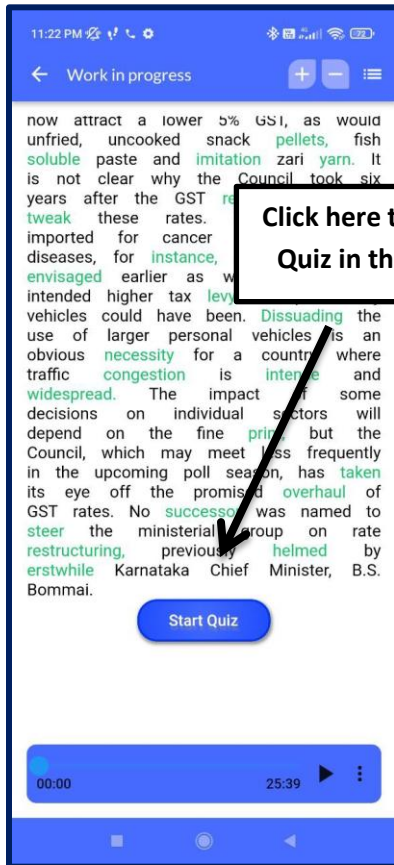
45. **Warrant** (verb) – Justify, necessitate, call for, validate, authorize उचित ठहराना

@mocks_wallah

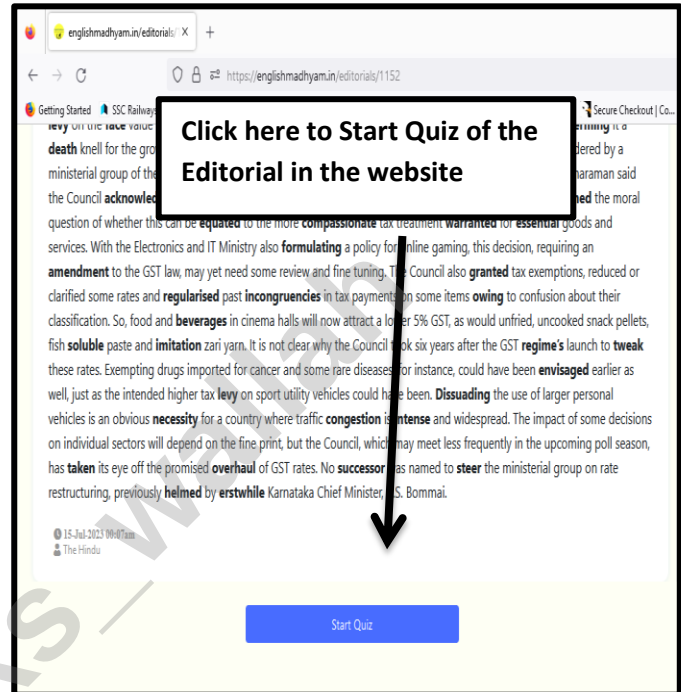
Summary of the Editorial

1. Author's Background – The author is an experienced arbitrator and dispute resolution board member for infrastructure projects, with 27 years of experience in the field.
2. Contract Execution Challenges – The author observes that securing a contract is easier than executing it, often due to ambiguity and poor understanding by both client and contractor.
3. Role of Consultants – Consultants are often brought into large projects to ensure smooth execution, but they sometimes add to confusion despite good intentions and documentation.
4. Parallel with Marriage – The author draws a comparison between infrastructure contracts and marital relationships, calling marriage a “contract without a written document.”
5. Pre-nuptial Agreements – Some young couples today opt for pre-nuptial agreements, reflecting growing awareness and willingness to define terms upfront.
6. Parental Involvement vs. Couple's Role – In traditional settings, parents define marriage terms, while the actual couple often stays disengaged, despite being better informed.
7. Modern Change in Attitudes – Encouragingly, many young people today are willing to take control of their own future, including relationship decisions.
8. Courtship as Evaluation Phase – Just like the bidding process in contracts, courtship or live-in relationships serve to test compatibility before formalizing the bond.
9. Techno-commercial Selection – The author humorously refers to marriage as being based on techno-commercial terms, acknowledging the practical aspects of matchmaking.
10. Ceremonial Formalization – Priests act as “consultants” from both sides during wedding ceremonies, often using ritualistic language that the couple barely understands.
11. Need for Clarity in Vows – Marriage vows, if made with clarity and prior understanding, can lead to happier, long-lasting relationships.
12. Emotional Imperfection – Despite best efforts and intentions, human emotions make relationships inherently imperfect.
13. Changing Values Across Generations – Older generations saw marriage as divine and unchangeable, while modern youth are more open to ending relationships that don't bring happiness.
14. Family Pressure and Reconciliation Attempts – Parents and elders may urge reconciliation, sometimes through mediators or “conciliators,” but it doesn't always succeed.
15. Termination Without Acrimony – Just like infrastructure projects, relationships can and should be ended peacefully if needed, with the understanding that life must go on.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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